

C.2.3 Exam Practice 3: Software Troubleshooting

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Score: 88%

Passing Score: 80%



Question 1

✓ Correct

The IT Department has learned that a new employee starts on Monday and will need a computer just before the weekend. There is a used PC in the storeroom. A "no operating system found" message appears when the computer is rebooted after a technician installs Windows 10 on the computer with the hard drive partition style set to support Unified Extensible Firmware Interface (UEFI). Determine which of the following scenarios would generate that message.

☒ Damaged hard drive ✓ Correct

☐ Corrupted MBR

☐ Application crash

☐ Faulty motherboard

Explanation

The hard drive stores the files for the operating system, so a damaged hard drive will generate the "no operating system found" message.

Applications do not load until after login, and the operating system would have to be found to load and display a login screen.

It is unlikely that a faulty motherboard would lead to a "no operating system found" error. It is more likely to cause the system not to boot, not recognize peripherals, or suffer the blue screen of death (BSOD).

Unified Extensible Firmware Interface (UEFI) generally does not interact with the Master Boot Record (MBR). The MBR is part of the legacy BIOS boot process.

Related Content

 4.2.5 Troubleshoot Boot Issues

 4.2.6 Lab: Troubleshoot Boot Issues

 14.4.8 Troubleshoot Boot Issues

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Question 2

✔ Correct

A new employee calls the help desk because their phone will not connect to the office Wi-Fi. When the technician asks about the phone model, the employee says it is an iPhone 7. The technician immediately knows the problem. Which of the following could be the problem?

☒ Configuration ✓ Correct

☐ Signal strength

☐ Throttling

☐ Interference

Explanation

Since the technician knew the problem based on the phone model, the most likely cause would involve configuration issues between the device and the wireless access point related to the 802.11 standard or the GHz frequency band being used by the Wi-Fi network.

Signal strength can be affected by distance but not likely by the phone model.

The phone model would not impact interference from other devices or thick walls or metal.

Concerning smartphones, throttling refers to a purposeful reduction in phone performance by a manufacturer's update to the device that instructs it not to perform at its maximum capabilities.

Topic: Supporting Mobile Software, Troubleshoot Mobile OS and App Software 20.2

Related Content

 9.4.5 Connectivity Issues

 10.3.1 Printer Connectivity Issues

 20.2.5 Troubleshoot Connectivity Issues

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Question 3

✔ Correct

While browsing the internet, a user receives a pop-up that states, "We have detected a Trojan virus. Click OK to begin the repair process." Out of fright, the user clicks OK. Given the following choices, what is the most likely outcome of the user's response?

- ☒ Unwanted notifications start popping up in Windows. ✓ Correct
- ☐ The user starts experiencing drive-by downloads.
- ☐ UAC will need to be enabled.
- ☐ Nothing happens because Windows BitLocker blocks the Trojan virus.

Explanation

Malware often targets the browser, so clicking on a website pop-up is likely to deliver some type of infection, such as adware, which will deliver unwanted notifications.

A drive-by download will infect a computer with malware because a user visited a malicious site. However, in this scenario, the user was not passive. They actively interacted with the pop-up to install the adware.

BitLocker is an encryption tool, not an antivirus tool.

User Account Controls (UACs) prevent the unauthorized use of administrative privileges. They are enabled by default but can be disabled.

Related Content

-  12.1.6 Privacy Settings
-  19.3.8 Browser Privacy Settings
-  19.4.2 Malware Payloads

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Question 4

✔ Correct

While researching and writing a paper on their home computer, a student notices an alert in the notification area that Windows Defender has expired and needs to be updated. The student is annoyed by the interruption but clicks on the alert and follows the update instructions. Later, the student told their parents that Defender expired, and they installed the update. The student's parents are panic-stricken. Determine the best reason for the parents' reaction from the information provided.

- ☐ The parents know the Windows Defender subscription was recently renewed.
- ☒ A malicious browser push notification tricked the student into downloading malware. ✓ Correct
- ☐ The parents have scheduled all updates to occur during the automatic maintenance window at 2:00 am.
- ☐ A malicious browser push notification tricked the student into a drive-by download.

Explanation

One way to infect a host with malware is to misuse the browser push notification system that allows a website to send messages. Often, these messages are designed to trick users into installing malware by disguising it as an antivirus update.

While this scenario describes a malicious browser push notification, it is not a drive-by download. In a drive-by attack, the computer is infected with malware simply by visiting a malicious site; there is no user installation.

Defender is a Windows built-in antivirus and firewall product, so it does not expire. Scheduled updates are irrelevant.

Defender has no subscription to be renewed because it is automatically installed on all Windows computers (starting with Windows 7).

Related Content

19.4.5 Desktop Alerts and Notifications

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Question 5

✔ Correct

To ensure the authenticity and authorization of a mobile app, a service provider issues a certificate to valid developers. Developers can use this certificate to sign their app, and to establish trust. Which of the following attributes of an app would likely disqualify as trustworthy?

- ☐ Duplicates the function of a VPN
- ☐ Duplicates the function of MDM
- ☒ Duplicates the function of core OS apps ✓ Correct
- ☐ Duplicates the function of IoT

Explanation

A mobile app that duplicates the function of core operating system (OS) apps would be at risk of not receiving trusted app status.

A virtual private network (VPN) is a secure tunnel created between two endpoints connected via an unsecured transport network. VPN operations are not proprietary.

Mobile-device management (MDM) is a software tool for tracking, controlling, and securing an organization's mobile infrastructure. MDMs are not proprietary.

Internet of Things (IoT) is a global network of personal devices, home appliances and control systems, and other items with network connectivity. An app could not duplicate IoT.

Related Content

 20.3.2 Mobile App Source Security Concerns

 20.3.3 Mobile Security Symptoms

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Question 6

✔ Correct

Rooting is typically an action related to Android, while jailbreaking is associated with iOS. They are both trying to accomplish the same goal. What is that goal?

☒ Gain unrestricted access. ✔ Correct

☐ Bootlegging

☐ Spoofing

☐ Publish malicious apps.

Explanation

The goal of rooting and jailbreaking is to gain unrestricted access, or privilege escalation, by subverting the security controls built into iOS or Android. This also has the side effect of leaving many security measures permanently disabled.

Publishing malicious apps is the purview of rogue developers. It is not the goal of rooting and jailbreaking.

Bootlegging is developing software that illegally copies or imitates a commercial product or brand.

Spoofing is developing a malicious app that spoofs a legitimate app by using a similar name, fake reviews, and automated downloads to boost its apparent popularity.

Related Content

20.3.1 Root Access Security Concerns

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Question 7

✕ Incorrect

Many mobile apps collect location data. Rogue apps could use location data for criminal purposes, such as burglary. However, many legitimate apps also track a mobile user's location. Why would a legitimate shopping app have an interest in a user's location?

- ☐ Clicks
- ☐ Redirection
- ☒ Geotagging ✕ Incorrect
- ☐ Targeted advertising ✓ Correct

Explanation

Legitimate shopping apps are interested in tracking a user's location for targeted advertising. For example, Facebook tracks the location of its users for that very reason, although it is facing scrutiny over privacy issues.

Geotagging is adding geographic data and location to photos. An app would not track a user's location to tag their pictures.

Redirection is a malware attack where the malware corrupts the Domain Name System (DNS) and search provider to force users to spoofed sites.

The pursuit of clicks typically is the area of interest for adware since developers are paid when users click on the advertisements.

Related Content

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Question 8

✔ Correct

A user experiences significant system instability on their computer. It frequently shuts down, freezes, reboots, and powers off with no accompanying error messages. Which of the following problems would cause this instability? (Select three.)

☒ Failing CPU ✔ Correct☒ Misconfigured firewall ✔ Correct☒ Overheating ✔ Correct☐ Too many connected devices**Explanation**

Excessive heat can damage computer circuitry and induce shutdowns, freezing, and reboots. A common cause of overheating is fans clogged with dust.

A failing CPU can lead to crashes, freezing, and reboots. Overheating and power surges are often to blame for damage to the CPU.

A misconfigured firewall introduces the risk of a malware infection that could cause some of these instability symptoms.

Too many connected devices will generate a warning message that there are not enough USB resources. This situation will not shut down the computer or make it freeze or reboot.

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14.4.12 Troubleshoot System Fault Issues

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Question 9

✕ Incorrect

The electronic health records software application crashes during a busy day at a doctor's office. The IT consultant for the practice knows that the application backs up data in real-time and has the latest update installed. Which of the following options is the only one that could potentially fix the crashing issue?

- ☐ Update the application driver.
- ☐ Uninstall and reinstall the application. ✓ Correct
- ☒ Try to recover data from temporary files. ✕ Incorrect
- ☐ Uninstall and reinstall the application driver.

Explanation

Since the most recent update to the application has been applied, uninstalling and then reinstalling the software is the best option of the available choices.

While preserving data is always a priority, there is no need to do so in this scenario since the application backs up in real-time. Additionally, it will not fix the problem.

Applications/software do not have drivers. Drivers are software that tells the operating system how to interact with their particular device/hardware. Drivers are updated to fix bugs and security holes or optimize the hardware.

Applications/software do not have drivers. Drivers are software that tells the operating system how to interact with their particular device/hardware. Uninstalling and reinstalling drivers is usually done when a device is malfunctioning.

Related Content

14.4.13 Troubleshoot Application and Service Fault Issues

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Question 10

✓ Correct

A researcher calls the help desk complaining of slow computer performance. When the technician arrives and probes for clues, the researcher explains that they frequently run multiple programs simultaneously and have a significant number of browser tabs open to aid with their research. Which of the following solutions should speed up the computer's performance?

- ☐ Run System Restore.
- ☐ Reset Windows.
- ☒ Add RAM. ✓ Correct
- ☐ Have the user run the computer in Safe Mode with Networking.

Explanation

Running multiple programs and having a lot of browser tabs open consumes a lot of RAM. Since the researcher needs to continue this practice to do their job, adding more RAM should improve performance.

System Restore is mostly used to roll back a configuration change, such as installing or updating. It does not help with memory-constrained performance.

Safe Mode is a troubleshooting environment that loads only the basic drivers and services required to start the system. While running Safe Mode with Networking allows internet access, the environment is not conducive to resource-consuming programs.

Resetting Windows using Reset this PC restores the computer's factory default settings and removes all applications.

Related Content

-  4.3.4 Troubleshoot Performance Issues
-  14.4.6 Update and Driver Roll Back
-  14.4.11 Troubleshoot Performance Issues
-  14.4.12 Troubleshoot System Fault Issues

resources\questions\pt_core2_220_1202_3_1_010.question.xml

Question 11

✓ Correct

An employee enters the web address of their local newspaper to check for news on the company, and a site pops up with many click-bait celebrity stories. The employee re-enters the address, assuming a misspelling, but returns to the same page. When the help desk technician arrives, which of the following troubleshooting steps would be appropriate?

- ☐ Check the System Configuration Utility.
- ☐ Check to see if the newspaper website's certificate is expired.
- ☐ Check to see if the DNS browser is configured correctly.
- ☒ Check HOSTS files for malicious entries. ✓ Correct

Explanation

This scenario describes a redirection when a user tries to open one page but is sent to another. Here, it appears adware is driving traffic to another site to increase clicks. Since HOSTS maps domain names to IP addresses, the HOSTS file in the registry would show malicious entries to re-route IP addresses.

The Domain Name Server (DNS) is a server, not a browser. However, the nslookup command can be used to check DNS records.

Any problem with a website's certificate will likely generate a message. It will not send a user to another website.

The System Configuration Utility modifies various settings and files that affect how the computer boots and loads Windows.

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 19.4.7 Troubleshoot Browser Symptoms

 20.3.3 Mobile Security Symptoms

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Question 12

✓ Correct

Worried about a crash, a user creates a complete backup of the system configuration and data files on their computer. Identify what the user has created.

- ☐ An update
- ☐ A reimage
- ☐ An update rollback
- ☒ An image ✓ Correct

Explanation

A backup of everything on the computer, including the installation, settings, apps, and files, is also called an image.

Reimaging is not a backup. It removes system files and resets all PC settings to default, usually done when the hard disk or operating system is damaged or malware-infected.

An update fixes or improves the computer's operating system, drivers, or software. Nothing else is changed, and nothing on the computer is backed up.

If an update to Windows or an application/program causes problems with the computer, it can be rolled back (uninstalled).

Related Content

-  14.4.4 System Restore
-  14.4.6 Update and Driver Roll Back
-  14.4.7 System Repair, Reinstall, and Reimage
-  14.4.12 Troubleshoot System Fault Issues

resources\questions\pt_core2_220_1202_3_1_003.question.xml

Question 13

✔ Correct

The Snapchat app on an iOS phone will not close. The user rebooted the device, but that was unsuccessful. Which of the following options would be the best for the user to try to fix the problem?

- ☐ Factory Reset
- ☐ Wiping
- ☒ Uninstall, then reinstall ✓ Correct
- ☐ System updates

Explanation

Uninstalling and then reinstalling an app can fix issues such as failing to close. To uninstall an iOS app, tap-and-hold it until it wiggles, then press the X icon and confirm by pressing Delete.

System updates is an Android option. The comparable iOS option is Software Update.

Wiping a device performs a factory default reset and clears all data, apps, and settings. This is an extreme solution for an app issue. A device wipe is typically used if a device is lost to protect data and account credentials.

A factory reset removes all user data, apps, and settings. This is a last resort since the device will have to be manually reconfigured or restored from a backup configuration, if available.

Related Content

 20.2.1 Mobile Device Troubleshooting Tools

 20.2.4 Troubleshoot App Issues

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Question 14

✔ Correct

Which of the following scenarios would result in a website having an untrusted or invalid certificate? (Select three.)

- ☐ The certificate is issued by a trusted CA.
- ☒ The certificate is self-signed. ✓ Correct
- ☒ The certificate is revoked. ✓ Correct
- ☒ The certificate has expired. ✓ Correct

Explanation

Certificate warnings occur when a certificate is untrusted, such as a self-signed certificate, the padlock icon is replaced by an alert icon, the URL is displayed with strike-through formatting, and the site content is likely to be blocked by a warning message.

Certificate warnings occur with an invalid certificate, such as an expired certificate.

Certificate warnings occur when a certificate is invalid, such as a revoked certificate. A certificate could be revoked because the site is misconfigured or malware attempts to direct the browser to a spoofed page.

Certificate warnings occur when a certificate is untrusted. A certificate issued by a trusted Certificate Authority (CA) would be a trusted certificate.

Related Content

 19.3.7 Secure Connections and Valid Certificates

 19.4.7 Troubleshoot Browser Symptoms

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Question 15

— Partial

A user's phone begins to act strangely, with apps responding slowly and pop-up ads appearing frequently. When the user calls the help desk and explains the issues, the technician says it sounds like malware. What other symptoms would be common to a malware infection on a mobile phone? (Select two.)

- ☐ APK sideloading
- ☐ Redirection ✓ Correct
- ☒ Decreased response times ✗ Incorrect
- ☒ Fake security warnings ✓ Correct

Explanation

Fake security warnings are a common symptom of malware infection. Scareware uses these to persuade users to install an app or give a Trojan app additional permissions.

Redirection attacks are a common symptom, where malware corrupts the Domain Name System (DNS) and search provider to force users to spoofed sites. This might disrupt access to legitimate sites, generate certificate warnings, and cause slow network performance.

APK (Android Package) sideloading refers to downloading apps for Android phones from a source other than Google's Play Store.

Malware might cause excessive power drain, high resource utilization, and increased response times.

Related Content

 19.4.7 Troubleshoot Browser Symptoms

 20.3.3 Mobile Security Symptoms

resources\questions\pt_core2_220_1202_3_3_003.question.xml

Question 16

✔ Correct

A teenager hears from friends about a legitimate website to download games to their Samsung Galaxy phone that is not in the Google Play store. The teenager goes to the site and downloads some games. What best describes the teenager's behavior?

☒ APK sideloading ✔ Correct

☐ Rooting

☐ Bootlegging

☐ Jailbreaking

Explanation

APK (Android Package) is the file format for Android apps. APK sideloading refers to downloading apps from a source other than Google's Play Store.

Jailbreaking removes the protective seal and any operating system-specific restrictions to give users greater control over the device. iOS jailbreaking is accomplished by booting the device with a patched kernel.

Rooting or gaining root access on an Android-based phone means gaining super user-level access over the device.

A bootleg app is software that illegally copies or imitates a commercial product or brand. In this scenario, the teenager used a legitimate site.

Related Content

 20.3.2 Mobile App Source Security Concerns

 20.3.3 Mobile Security Symptoms

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Question 17

✔ Correct

A telltale sign of a malware infection is when changes occur to system files. Which of the following is likely the result of malware-induced changes to system files? (Select two.)

- ☐ Known-good files with expired certificates
- ☒ Files that are missing or renamed ✓ Correct
- ☒ Files with date stamps and file sizes that are different from known-good versions ✓ Correct
- ☐ Additional files with names similar to authentic system files, such as scvhost.docx or ta5kmgr.xlsx

Explanation

System files are an attractive target for malware because renaming or deleting them can wreak havoc on the operating system.

Hackers will alter the size of system files to hide malware or change the date stamp to cover their tracks.

While malware will add additional files with names almost the same as authentic system files, the extensions .docx and .xlsx represent Word and Excel files, respectively. These are data files, not system files. System files have extensions such as .dll and .sys.

System files do not have certificates. Certificates are a security tool used by websites to prove the server is trusted.

Related Content

19.4.4 Troubleshoot PC Security Symptoms

resources\questions\pt_core2_220_1202_3_4_006.question.xml

Question 18

✓ Correct

A user downloads an instant messaging app from the Apple store and then gets requests for permission to access their camera; which of the following is the most likely cause of the permission requests?

☒ Spoofed app ✓ Correct

☐ Locator app

☐ Sideloaded app

☐ Enterprise app

Explanation

A spoofed app is a malicious app that spoofs a legitimate app by using a similar name, fake reviews, and automated downloads to boost its apparent popularity. Once downloaded, it will act as spyware and may request permissions unrelated to its function.

Sideloaded is downloading apps from a source other than a trusted store. In this scenario, the app was downloaded from the trusted Apple store.

An enterprise app is a custom corporate app.

A locator app is a cloud app that uses a mobile-device location service to identify its current position on a map and enable security features to mitigate theft or loss.

Related Content

 20.3.2 Mobile App Source Security Concerns

 20.3.3 Mobile Security Symptoms

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Question 19

✓ Correct

While conducting an online search for cleaning services, a homeowner clicks on the link for one of the results. When the website loads, the page says, "Warning: Potential Security Risk Ahead." What would cause this message to appear? (Select all that apply.)

- ☒ The certificate is issued by an untrusted CA. ✓ Correct
- ☒ Malware is trying to redirect the browser to a spoofed page. ✓ Correct
- ☐ The cleaning service is no longer in business.
- ☒ The certificate has expired. ✓ Correct

Explanation

Suppose a certificate was issued by a Certificate Authority (CA) untrusted. In that case, the URL is displayed with strike-through formatting, and the site content is likely to be blocked by a warning message.

If a certificate is expired, the site content is likely blocked by a warning message.

A warning message could indicate that malware on the computer is attempting to redirect the browser to a spoofed page.

Even if the cleaning service went out of business and shut down its website, it would not generate a security message.

Related Content

 19.3.7 Secure Connections and Valid Certificates

 19.4.7 Troubleshoot Browser Symptoms

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Question 20

✔ Correct

What are the options when a company wants to create and deliver a custom app for its employees without using a public store? (Select two.)

☒ Managed Google Play ✔ Correct

☐ Bootleg App Store

☒ Apple Business Manager ✔ Correct

☐ Developer Mode

Explanation

Apple operates enterprise developer and distribution programs to allow private app distribution via Apple Business Manager.

Google's Play Store has a private channel option for enterprise app distribution called Managed Google Play.

Developer mode is a mobile-device feature designed for testing apps during development. It has no connection to how an app is delivered, whether publicly or privately.

A bootleg app store is where users can find bootleg apps that closely mimic legitimate apps; this is a way of pirating apps without paying for them. It is not a private distribution channel.

Related Content

20.3.2 Mobile App Source Security Concerns

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